iCog Labs Intern Guideline

Internship Program Knowledge Document

1. About iCog Labs

iCog Labs was founded in April 2013 by Ethiopian entrepreneur Getnet Aseffa Gezaw and cognitive scientist Dr. Ben Goertzel. iCog Labs is East Africa's first private artificial intelligence (AI) and robotics research and development company.

iCog Labs specialises in artificial intelligence. Its focus areas are machine learning, computational linguistics, computer vision, mobile robotics, and artificial general intelligence (AGI). The company's team of software and business development experts is dedicated to advancing science and technology for the benefit of humanity, with a commitment to using innovative AI to help Africa make strides into the future.

2. Purpose of This Document

This document is the intern guideline of iCog Labs. It introduces the values, processes, rules and resources that support every iCog Labs intern. It gives clear guidance on the responsibilities, rights and opportunities of interns so that they can navigate the internship confidently.

3. What This Document Covers

- **Office locations and contacts** – where iCog Labs is located and whom interns can contact.
- **Internship objectives, rights and responsibilities** – what the program is for and what interns must do.
- **Teams and departments** – the project teams an intern can join.
- **Training sessions and courses** – Saturday training, online courses and course recommendations.
- **The group system (G1 to G10 and Group 11)** – how interns are grouped, marked and ranked.
- **Intern-to-staff transition** – how an intern becomes a full-time staff member of iCog Labs.
- **Frequently asked questions** – short answers to the most common intern questions.

4. Office Locations of iCog Labs

iCog Labs has two offices in Addis Ababa. Interns can use the following addresses to find iCog Labs.

Office	Location
Main office	Around Matemiya, Bole
Branch office	Around Welo Sefer

The main office of iCog Labs is located around Matemiya, in the Bole area. The branch office of iCog Labs is located around Welo Sefer. Interns complete their required in-person office hours at the iCog Labs offices.

5. Key Contacts for Interns

Interns who have questions or need support during the internship at iCog Labs should contact the following people.

Contact	Purpose and details
HR Team	Inquiries about the internship, mentoring and workplace concerns. Email: icoglabs89@gmail.com
HR Head Team	Escalation contact. If an intern's case is not addressed to their satisfaction by the HR team, the intern can email the HR head team at icoghrteam1@gmail.com.
Mentor	The designated mentor provides guidance and support throughout the internship.
Team Lead	Project-specific questions or collaboration needs. Contact the team lead of the intern's own team.

6. Communication and Reporting

Effective communication is essential for a successful internship at iCog Labs. Interns are encouraged to keep open lines of communication with their mentors and team members. Regular updates on project progress, and any challenges faced, should be reported promptly. Interns should use official channels for communication and submit all relevant documentation on time. This practice fosters collaboration and also supports the intern's professional development.

7. Internship Objectives

The iCog Labs Internship Program is designed to give interns hands-on experience in artificial intelligence, machine learning, robotics and blockchain, while working together with industry professionals on innovative projects.

The objectives of the iCog Labs internship program are:

- To support the personal and professional growth of interns.
- To identify dedicated individuals and evaluate their potential for joining the iCog Labs team as staff.
- To let interns do meaningful work that challenges them to apply their skills and learn new ones.
- To let interns contribute to groundbreaking solutions that advance technology.
- To offer networking opportunities with peers and mentors, creating a supportive environment for future career development.

8. Rights of iCog Labs Interns

Every iCog Labs intern has the right to:

- Choose a mentor to guide them throughout the internship.
- Change mentors if necessary, with proper notification to the HR team.
- Report any workplace issue to the HR team.

9. Responsibilities of iCog Labs Interns

Every iCog Labs intern is responsible for the following:

- Dedicating at least **40 hours per month in the office** (in person).
- Attending the mandatory training sessions and completing the required online courses (at least six courses).
- Updating their CV regularly. CVs are reviewed weekly, and interns should read the CV Guideline carefully.
- Respecting confidentiality regarding company information and proprietary data.
- Maintaining a professional demeanour, including decency in all interactions.
- Presenting their assigned project on Thursday and keeping up with Saturday training.

10. Teams and Departments

At iCog Labs, interns can join various teams and departments. This allows them to work on diverse projects and gain valuable experience. Each team focuses on a different area of innovation and technology, which encourages collaboration and knowledge sharing.

11. Available Teams for Interns

No.	Team	No.	Team
1	Mindplex	10	Qwestor
2	Rejuve Bio	11	Continual Learning
3	Hyperion Mosse	12	Subrep Project
4	Hyperion Pattern Minor	13	MusicAI
5	NAC	14	MathematicsAI
6	Conceptual Blending	15	Cordinal Miner
7	Hyperon OpenPsi	16	HyperClaw
8	Quantum Computing Team	17	SophiaVerse: Games AI
9	AI Video Generation	18	Hopefield

In total there are 18 teams available to iCog Labs interns: Mindplex, Rejuve Bio, Hyperion Mosse, Hyperion Pattern Minor, NAC, Conceptual Blending, Hyperon OpenPsi, Quantum Computing Team, AI Video Generation, Qwestor, Continual Learning, Subrep Project, MusicAI, MathematicsAI, Cordinal Miner, HyperClaw, SophiaVerse: Games AI, Hopefield.

12. Choosing a Team

To find out more about each team, interns follow the team links provided in the original iCog Labs guideline. To help interns choose the right team, iCog Labs provides a **Project Guide: Course Recommendations** document. It offers tailored course recommendations for each project. Interns can also ask their mentor, who may give extra advice and course suggestions.

Each intern works with a designated mentor and with the lead of the chosen team. For project-specific questions or collaboration needs, the intern contacts the team lead; for guidance and support throughout the internship, the intern contacts the mentor.

13. Training Sessions

As part of the internship at iCog Labs, interns take part in structured training sessions designed to improve their skills and knowledge in various fields. Training sessions take place regularly, typically on **Saturdays**, and cover essential topics relevant to the intern's role, following the iCog Labs Training Guideline.

Rules for training sessions:

- Interns must attend all scheduled training sessions to maximise their learning and engagement.
- Training is conducted by iCog Labs staff members.
- Interns are graded on their attendance and engagement.
- To become eligible for staff membership, an intern must complete a **minimum of 10 training sessions**.
- Missing a training session results in negative marks and can send the intern to Group 11.

14. Mandatory Online Courses

In addition to training sessions, every iCog Labs intern must complete courses on online platforms. An intern must finish **at least 6 courses** on online platforms during the internship. The course topics cover essential skills and knowledge areas in artificial intelligence, machine learning, robotics, and more.

- **Course suggestions:** mentors may give additional course suggestions to further enhance the intern's learning.
- **Project Guide: Course Recommendations:** a document with tailored course recommendations for each project, to help interns choose the right team.
- **AGI course recommendation material:** curriculum material that supports an intern's path to becoming an AGI engineer or researcher.

15. Why Courses Matter

Completing online courses is a requirement for becoming a staff member. Taking **new online courses** is also one of the ways that an intern in Group 11 can be moved back into one of the regular groups (see the Group 11 section). Interns should actively engage in all training sessions and courses to get the most from the internship.

16. The Group System of iCog Labs Interns

During the internship period, iCog Labs divides its interns into groups. There are **10 regular groups**, named **G1 up to G10**. Each regular group has **10 interns**, so the regular groups together hold 100 interns. In addition to these, there is one special group called **Group 11**, which has around 50 interns (see the Group 11 section).

Group	Members	Description
G1 to G10	10 interns each	Regular groups. G1 is the highest-ranked group and G10 the lowest-ranked regular group.
Group 11	Around 50 interns	Special group for interns who failed to meet requirements and received negative marks.

17. Weekly Cycle: Saturday Training and Thursday Presentation

The groups G1 to G10 follow a weekly cycle of training, project work and presentation:

- **Saturday – Training.** The groups G1 to G10 attend the Saturday training session. During the training, each group is given a project.
- **Thursday – Presentation.** The interns present the project they were given on Saturday on the following Thursday.
- **Marking.** After the presentation, every intern is given a mark from 1 to 10.

18. Why Attendance at Both Events Matters

An intern must attend the Saturday training and must make the Thursday presentation. Missing a training session or missing a presentation results in negative marks. An intern who collects negative marks, together with other failures such as not completing the 40 required in-person office hours, can be moved into Group 11.

The marks given for the Thursday presentation decide the group the intern belongs to. The next section explains exactly how marks translate into groups.

19. Marks and Group Placement

Every iCog Labs intern receives a mark from **1 to 10** for the project presentation. The mark decides the group of the intern. An intern who scores **10** goes to **Group 1 (G1)**, an intern who scores **9** goes to **Group 2 (G2)**, and so on down the scale.

Mark	Group	Mark	Group
10	G1	5	G6
9	G2	4	G7
8	G3	3	G8
7	G4	2	G9
6	G5	1	G10

20. Ranking Inside a Group and Moving Between Groups

Interns are ranked within their group according to their marks. After each round of marking, interns join the group that matches their new mark, so an intern's group is not fixed. An intern can move up to a higher group (for example from G5 to G2) by scoring better, and can move down to a lower group by scoring worse.

Example: an intern in G4 who scores 10 in the next presentation joins G1. An intern in G1 who scores 6 in the next presentation joins G5.

21. Why Group Position Matters

The overall performance and attendance of an intern during the internship determine the intern's grouping for evaluation purposes. Being in the top 5 of Group 1 shows that the intern is active and dedicated, which is a positive sign when iCog Labs considers the intern for the intern-to-staff transition evaluation.

Interns in the higher groups (G1, G2, G3) are therefore in the strongest position. Interns in the lower groups can still improve their position in the following rounds by working harder and scoring higher marks.

22. Group 11: The Special Group

Group 11 is a special group at iCog Labs. It has around **50 interns**. Group 11 holds the interns who failed to do the requirements of the internship and therefore received negative marks.

23. Reasons an Intern Is Placed in Group 11

- Not completing the required **40 hours in person** in the office during the month.
- Missing a training session.
- Missing a project presentation.
- Other failures to meet the internship requirements.

Each of these failures gives negative marks, and an intern with negative marks is placed in Group 11 instead of one of the regular groups G1 to G10.

24. How an Intern Leaves Group 11

Group 11 members are not stuck in the group. Interns in Group 11 can be **distributed to the other groups** (G1 to G10) in two ways:

- When they **take new courses on online platforms**.
- When the **month ends**.

Situation	What happens
Intern fails requirements and gets negative marks	The intern is placed in Group 11.
Intern in Group 11 takes new online courses	The intern can be distributed to another group.
The month ends	Group 11 members can be distributed to other groups.

25. Advice for Group 11 Interns

An intern in Group 11 should start new online courses as early as possible, attend every Saturday training, make every Thursday presentation, and complete the 40 office hours of the month. Doing so helps the intern rejoin the regular groups and return to the path toward becoming a staff member.

26. Intern-to-Staff Transition

One objective of the iCog Labs internship is to identify dedicated interns and evaluate their potential for joining the iCog Labs team. An iCog Labs intern can become a **staff member** of the company and work as a **full-time employee**.

27. Requirements to Become a Staff Member

An intern can become a staff member when the intern fulfils all of the following:

- Completes a **minimum of 10 training sessions**.
- Finishes **at least 6 courses** on online platforms.
- **Passes the evaluation**.

Requirement	Minimum
Training sessions completed	10
Online platform courses finished	6
Evaluation	Must be passed
Result	Becomes a full-time staff member

28. Performance Evaluation

The overall performance and attendance of the intern during the internship determine the intern's grouping for evaluation purposes. Being in the top 5 of Group 1 shows that the intern is active and dedicated, which is a positive sign for consideration in the intern-to-staff transition evaluation.

29. Professional Development Opportunities

iCog Labs supports the growth of its interns through networking events with industry professionals, specialised workshops, and mentorship. Regular feedback sessions help interns track their progress and improve their skills, preparing them for a successful career in technology.

30. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Where is iCog Labs located?
A: iCog Labs has a main office around Matemiya, in the Bole area, and a branch office around Welo Sefer.

Q: Who founded iCog Labs and when?
A: iCog Labs was founded in April 2013 by Ethiopian entrepreneur Getnet Aseffa Gezaw and cognitive scientist Dr. Ben Goertzel.

Q: How many hours must an intern spend in the office?
A: At least 40 hours per month, in person.

Q: How can an intern become a full-time staff member?
A: By completing at least 10 training sessions, finishing at least 6 online platform courses, and passing the evaluation.

Q: How many groups are there and how big are they?
A: There are 10 regular groups, G1 to G10, with 10 interns each, plus the special Group 11 with around 50 interns.

Q: When are the training and the presentation?
A: Training takes place on Saturday. Interns are given a project and present it on Thursday.

Q: How are marks and groups connected?
A: Marks range from 1 to 10. A mark of 10 means G1, 9 means G2, 8 means G3, and so on until a mark of 1 means G10.

Q: What is Group 11?
A: A special group of around 50 interns who failed the requirements, such as not completing 40 office hours, missing training or missing a presentation, and so received negative marks.

Q: How can an intern leave Group 11?
A: By taking new online courses, or when the month ends, Group 11 members can be distributed to the other groups.

Q: Can an intern change mentor?
A: Yes. An intern may change mentor if necessary, with proper notification to the HR team.

Q: Whom should an intern contact if HR does not solve the problem?
A: The HR head team, at icoghrteam1@gmail.com. The first contact is the HR team at icoglabs89@gmail.com.